Arab Open University
FACULTY OF LANGUAGE STUDIES

A215A
Creative Writing
All Branches
Final Exam-Main

2024-2025 /First Semester
Date: 9 Jan. 2025
9:30 – 12:30

Number of Exam Pages: 4 (including this cover sheet)	**Time Allowed: 3 hours**

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Read the questions carefully before you answer.
2. Answer all the questions in the answer booklet.
3. Write all your answers in ink NOT pencil.
4. Edit and proofread your language.

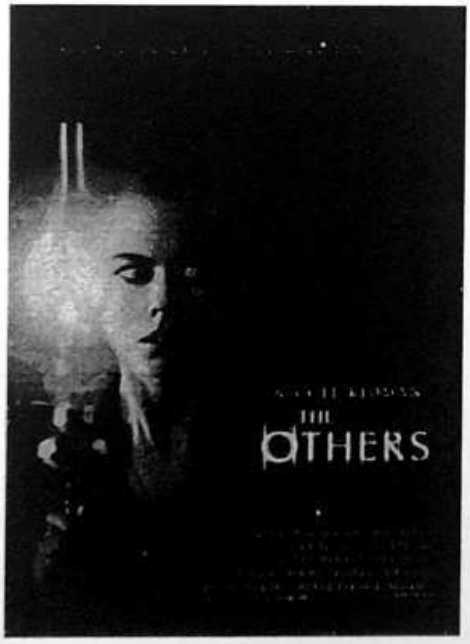
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Write Short Notes on the following (50 words each): (15 Marks)

a) The interaction of a character and a setting (4 Marks)
b) Feature Stories (4 Marks)
c) Hard news vs. soft news (4 Marks)
d) Three steps for planning and writing a film review (3Marks)

One of the most effective ways of revealing character is through details of the spaces they inhabit and the possessions they have chosen. A character's belongings can act as an index to his or her character. In 150 – 200 words, create a domestic setting for someone whose first day of employment was the worst in his life. Invent details when needed to highlight the impact of the setting on the character's mood and psyche. (10 Marks)

II. Read the following film review below. Do you believe that the film review creates a strong impression on readers? Justify your answer highlighting the message/theme of the film and whether cinematography conveys that message or not. Provide examples from the review to explain your answer. (10 Marks)



"The Others" is a haunted house mystery--from which you assume, trained by recent movies, that it is filled with flashy special effects, violent shocks, blood-curdling apparitions, undulating staircases, telescoping corridors, graves opening in the

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basement, doors that will not lock or will not open, and dialogue like "There's something in this house! Something . . . diabolic!" You would be right about the dialogue. This is a haunted house movie, dark and atmospheric, but it's quiet and brooding. It has less in common with, say, "The House on Haunted Hill" than with "The Sixth Sense" or a story by Oliver Onions. It's not a freak show but a waiting game, in which an atmosphere of dread slowly envelops the characters--too slowly.

Comparing this movie with "The Sixth Sense," we feel a renewed admiration for the way M. Night Shyamalan was able to maintain tension through little things that were happening, instead of (this film's strategy) big things that seem about to happen. The film takes place in an isolated manor on the island of Jersey, off the British coast. In this house lives Grace (Nicole Kidman) and her two children, the tremulous Nicholas (James Bentley) and the cheeky Anne (Alakina Mann). To the house one day come three servants, who are responding, or say they are responding, to Grace's advertisement for domestic help. There are vacancies because the previous servants decamped in the middle of the night without a word of notice. The three new applicants have the advantage of being familiar with the house.

It is a sound tradition of British fiction that servants do not leave a house only to later return and be rehired (the sole exception is George Wellbeloved, Lord Emsworth's pig-keeper at Blandings Castle). But these are the days immediately after World War II, which claimed, or seems to have claimed, Grace's husband in battle, and so perhaps help is hard to find. She hires them: Mrs. Mills (Fionnula Flanagan), the middle-aged Irish woman with the know-it-all nods, the young mute girl Lydia (Elaine Cassidy), and the gardener Mr. Tuttle (Eric Sykes), who is so ancient that for him planting a seed is an act of wild optimism. There are odd rules in the house. Each of the 50 doors must be locked before another can be opened. The curtains must always be drawn. These measures are necessary, Grace explains, because Anne and Nicholas are so allergic to the sunlight that they might die if exposed to it.

The film's events are such that I must not describe them. Even a hint might give away the game. Of course they are elusive and mysterious, reported by some, not seen by others, explained first one way and then another. By the time we arrive at the line "there's something in this house!" we are not only prepared to agree, but to suspect that in supernatural terms, it's as crowded as the Smithsonian's attic.

The director, Alejandro Amenabar, has the patience to create a languorous, dreamy atmosphere, and Nicole Kidman succeeds in convincing us that she is a normal person in a disturbing situation and not just a standard-issue horror movie hysteric. But in drawing out his effects, Amenabar is a little too confident that style can substitute for substance. As our suspense was supposed to be building, our impatience was outstripping it. As Houdini said, or should have if he didn't, you can only listen to so much spectral knocking before you want to look under the table.

Source:
https://www.rogerebert.com/reviews/the-others-2001

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IV. Write a 200-word film review for a film you watched taking into consideration the structure of a film review and using the language (vocabulary, phrases and expressions) required for analytical film reviews. This includes the language used in describing the background, main points of the plot, general points and opinions and useful recommendations. The general points and opinions should highlight the significance of impressive cinematic techniques in the movie. (15 Marks)

End of Exam

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